CBSE Class 10

English

Previous Year Question Paper 2014

Series: HRS **Code no. 2/1**

- Please check that this question paper contains **15** printed pages.
- Code number given on the right hand side of the question paper should be written on the title page of the answer-book by the candidate.
- Please check that this question paper contains **18** questions.
- **Please write down the Serial Number of the question before attempting it.**
- 15 minutes of time has been allotted to read this question paper. The question paper will be distributed at 10.15 a.m. From 10.15 a.m. to 10.30 a.m., the students will read the question paper only and will not write any answer on the answer script during this period.

SUMMATIVE ASSESSMENT - II

ENGLISH (Language and Literature)

Time Allowed: **3** hours Maximum Marks: **80**

General Instructions:

I. The Question paper is divided into four sections :

Section A — Reading	**15 marks**
Section B — Writing	**15 marks**
Section C — Grammar	**15 marks**
Section D —Text Books and Long Reading Text	**(25+10) = 35 marks**

II. **All** questions are compulsory.

III. Marks are indicated against each question.

SECTION – A

(Reading) **15 Marks**

1. Read the passage given below and complete the statements that follow by choosing the most appropriate options. **1×5 = 5 Marks**

Cheraw is the most colourful Mizo dance. Bamboos are used in this dance. Hence the dancer moves by stepping alternately in and out from between and across a pair of horizontal bamboos, held against the ground by people sitting face to face at either side. They tap the bamboos open and close in rhythmic beats. Two bases support the bamboos, placed horizontally, one at each end. The bamboos, when clapped, produce a sharp sound, which forms the rhythm of the dance. It indicates the timing of the dance as well. The dancers step in and out to the beats of the bamboos with ease and grace. The patterns and stepping of the dance have many variations. Sometimes the steppings are made in imitation of the movements of birds, sometimes the swaying of trees and so on. Little is known about the origin of Cheraw. It may be possible that the forefathers of the Mizos brought it with them when they left home in Far-East Asia. Cheraw is performed on any occasion these days. But, so goes the legend. It used to be performed in earlier times only to ensure a safe passage for a dead child to paradise. Cheraw is, therefore, a dance of sanctification and redemption performed with great care, precision and elegance.

(a) According to the passage, Cheraw is _____ .

(i) a form of art

(ii) a festival of lights

(iii) a form of dance

(iv) a Mizo animal

Ans: (iii) a form of dance

(b) Cheraw is performed _____ .

(i) to show respect to the state

(ii) for sanctification and redemption

(iii) to please the goddess of dance

(iv) to earn money

Ans: (ii) for sanctification and redemption

(c) The dancers in Cheraw dance to _____ .

(i) the beats of bamboos

(ii) the beats of drums

(iii) the clappings of the singers

(iv) the sound of a whistle

Ans: (i) the beats of bamboos

(d) The statement — _____ is correct.

(i) Four bases support the bamboos

(ii) Cheraw is a solo dance

(iii) Cheraw is a dull stepping pattern

(iv) The sound of bamboos forms the rhythm of the dance

Ans: (iv) The sound of bamboos forms the rhythm of the dance

(e) The word 'redemption' in the passage means _____ .

(i) performed with great care

(ii) solution

(iii) deliverance from evil ways

(iv) compensation

Ans: (iii) deliverance from evil ways

2. Read the passage given below and complete the statements that follow by choosing the most appropriate options. 1 × 5 = 5 Marks

Himalayan valley is the geographical guard of the Indian territory against any foreign invasion keeping the enemy at bay from the western to the eastern subcontinent of the Asian sphere. The valley abounds with a classified variety

of different glaciers, wildlife, peaks and thick vegetation liable to support the homo sapiens.

Pindari glacier is a range of four glaciers, namely Sunderdunga, Namik, Pindari and Kafni. To go to Pindari glacier it is a 54 km trek and the walking part is normally covered in four days. In this trek, we cross many mountains and forests and see a lot of wildlife. We were eight members in the team. The whole trip took us ten days in the mountains. Throughout the way, our guide and my father explained to us the various features of the Himalayas we were passing through. We had to face bad weather for two days. There was a steep climb at some places and as we climbed up we were affected by high altitude sickness and lack of oxygen and we felt very tired.

Pindari glacier is surrounded on all sides by snow-covered peaks such as Nanda Devi, Nanda Kot, Nanda Khat, Bailiuri and many more. This glacier is a frozen river of ice and settled in such a way that it looks like a huge staircase. There I saw all physical features such as gorges, moraines, hanging valleys, etc.

(a) Pindari glacier is _____ .

- **(i) a glacier range of four mountains namely Sunderdunga, Namik, Pindari and Kafni**
- **(ii) a mountain peak surrounded by Sunderdunga, Namik and Kafni**
- **(iii) a forest in the Himalayan region**
- **(iv) a range of four glaciers, namely Sunderdunga, Namik, Pindari and Kafni**

Ans: (i) a glacier range of four mountains namely Sunderdunga, Namik, Pindari and Kafni

(b) A trip to Pindari glacier _____ .

- **(i) is very informative**
- **(ii) helps in understanding the natural geography**
- **(iii) is an adventurous experience as one has to face bad weather and difficult treks**
- **(iv) is all of the above**

Ans: (iii) is an adventurous experience as one has to face bad weather and difficult treks

(c) _____ made the members suffer while trekking to their destination.

(i) Steep climb and lack of oxygen

(ii) High altitude sickness, lack of oxygen and steep climb

(iii) Lack of oxygen and tiredness

(iv) Lack of oxygen and snow-covered peaks

Ans: (ii) High altitude sickness, lack of oxygen and steep climb

(d) The temperature in the area is _____ .

(i) normal

(ii) below zero degree

(iii) very high

(iv) warm

Ans: (ii) below zero degree

(e) The word in the passage which means the same as 'characteristics' is _____ .

(i) features

(ii) altitude

(iii) treks

(iv) gorges

Ans: (i) features

3. Read the poem given below and answer the questions that follow :

1 × 5 = 5 Marks

A nightingale, that all day long

Had cheered the village with his song,

Nor yet at eve his note suspended,

Nor yet when eventide was ended,

Began to feel, as well he might,

The keen demands of appetite;

When, looking eagerly around,

He spied far off, upon the ground,

A something shining in the dark,

And knew the glow-worm by his spark;

So, stooping down from hawthorn top,

He thought to put him in his crop.

The worm, aware of his intent,

Harangued him thus, right eloquent –

'Did you admire my lamp,' quoth he,

'As much as I your minstrelsy,

You would abhor to do me wrong,

As much as I to spoil your song;

For 'twas the self-same power divine,

Taught you to sing, and me to shine.'

(William Cowper)

(a) How was the nightingale busy for the whole day ?

Ans: All day long, the nightingale was busy singing and uplifting the villagers with her wonderful voice and song.

(b) How did the nightingale recognize the glow-worm ?

Ans: The nightingale recognises the glow-worm by the glow-glittering worm's lamp's light.

(c) Why was the glow-worm feeling scared ?

Ans: The glow-worm was spotted by the nightingale when it was seeking for food. The glow-worm was scared of becoming prey to the nightingale because it was aware of the nightingale's objectives.

(d) With what words of wisdom did the glow-worm persuade the nightingale not to do him any wrong ?

Ans: The nightingale is persuaded to do no damage by the glow-swift worm's and astute reasoning. It begins to praise and congratulate the nightingale. The glow-worm goes on to say that, just as the nightingale brightens up the day, the glow-worm brightens up the night with its light. It claims that because they are both God's created with distinct purposes, they should live in peace with one another.

(e) Find the word from the poem which means the same as 'loudly appealed to persuade'.

Ans: The term "harangued" means "loudly appealed to persuade."

SECTION – B

(Writing) 15 Marks

4. You are Rahul / Rohini, a resident of K-Block, Rajouri Garden, New Delhi.

Your friend Rajat / Rajni, who lives in another city, has met with an accident in which he / she has fractured his / her leg. Fortunately the injury is not very serious but he / she will have to miss his / her SA-II Examination (or final examination). Write a letter, in about 120 words, to enquire about his / her well-being, cheering him / her up, playing down the seriousness of missing the examination. Wish him / her a speedy recovery. 5 Marks

Ans:

Examination Hall

23/03/2018

Dear Rajat,

Your letter was received by me. I'm sorry to hear about your accident and the fact that you won't be able to complete your final exams. I understand the anxiety and stress you're experiencing. But, my friend, you must understand that your health is your most valuable asset. Exams occur on a regular basis. Every step of our lives serves as a test. We can speak with your teachers, and I am confident that they will administer your term end exams later.

I hope your wishes come true soon. I wish you the best of luck. Please convey my greetings to aunty and uncle. Greetings, Diksha.

Thank you.

Yours lovingly,

Rahul

Or

You are Rahul / Rohini, a resident of J-Block, Rajouri Garden, New Delhi.

The water pipe that supplies drinking water to your area is damaged and there has not been any water supply for two days now. Write a letter, in about 120 words, to the editor of a local daily drawing the attention of the authorities towards the difficulties of the residents and asking for immediate repair of the pipe. Demand the supply of drinking water through tankers. 5 Marks

Ans:

The Editor

Times of India

23/03/2018

J-Block

Rajouri Garden

New Delhi

Subject: Water shortage in our neighbourhood has been a source of contention.

Respected Sir,

I live in your neighbourhood. I'd like to raise your attention to a two-day water supply outage caused by a damaged water pipe that feeds water to our region. I filed a formal complaint with the authorities, but no action has yet been taken. Water is

in short supply, and there isn't enough in our location to meet our basic needs. People are forced to rely on costly water tankers.

This isn't the first time we've encountered this problem. In our neighbourhood, this is a common occurrence. I humbly request that you publish my piece in your newspaper and make the right authorities aware of it.

Thank you.

Yours Sincerely,

Rohini

5. Midday meal programme of the government started with the noble objective of encouraging children to come to school and improve their nutritional status. But reports of the recent death of 23 children in Bihar and other incidents of negligence in cooking the midday meal has produced an alarming effect on the minds of the parents. You are Akshit / Akshita, Head Boy / Head Girl of your school. Write an article, in 120 – 150 words, on the topic — 'Midday Meal Scheme — How to improve it ?'. 5 Marks

Ans:

Midday Meal Scheme — How to improve it

The Tamil Nadu government has launched a programme aimed at improving the nutritional status of children across the state. It was a commendable move toward improving health, reducing absenteeism, and increasing school enrollment. It began with the goal of improving students' nutritional status and enhancing their lives, but due to widespread corruption in the country, it has now become a hazard to children. The recent death of 23 children at a Bihar school demonstrates the absence of school management. It has had a significant impact on parents' attitudes. To avoid such circumstances, careful attention must be paid to food distribution. Parents should help prepare meals for their children, and government officials should visit kitchens where children's food is prepared on a regular basis. Only in this manner will we be able to make our idea a success.

Head Girl,

Akshita

Or

You are Akshit / Akshita, Head Boy / Head Girl of your school. You are worried about the outbreak of dengue fever after the rainy season. Write a speech, in 120 – 150 words, for the morning assembly of your school, expressing your shock over hundreds of cases admitted to various hospitals. Talk about dengue as a life-threatening viral disease, causes of its spread, symptoms and preventive measures. 5 Marks

Ans:

Report on the outbreak of dengue fever after the rainy season

By, Akshita

Teachers, good morning, and hello, my dear friends. I'm Akshita, a student in our school's XI grade, and as the head girl, I'd like to raise your attention to a dengue fever outbreak in the city caused by increased mosquito breeding during this rainy season. A large number of individuals are being admitted to hospitals, and a high number of people are dying. I respectfully suggest that you all wear full-sleeved shirts and long socks. Please also use mosquito repellent on any exposed regions of your body.

Please do not allow stagnant water to accumulate in your house or on school grounds. If you notice anything like this happening at school, either contact a teacher or report it to me. As we all know, "prevention is better than cure," so please join us in our school's cleanliness campaign, which begins today. Stay safe and happy.

6. Your city celebrated 'Vijay Dashmi' / Dussehra. As a reporter of your school magazine, write a report in 120 – 150 words, mentioning the crowds, arrangements, dignitaries present, the celebrations, fire-works and crackers. 5 Marks

Ans:

Report on Dussehra Celebration in school

ABC school celebrated Dussehra celebration on October 29, 2017 in the school auditorium, keeping the festive atmosphere alive. At around 9:30 a.m., the principal guests received diya enlightenment, which was followed by cultural performances, sketches, and a play based on the Ramayana epic. Following that, a fancy dress competition was held, in which small children dressed up as Ramayana characters amused the audience with their comic-dramatic presence.

They wore bright clothes that attracted everyone's attention on the day. Following the performances, our school principal, Mr. Chandilal, addressed the audience, emphasising the significance of the day as the triumph of good over evil, before bidding farewell to the visitors. After that, the audience dispersed while refreshments were distributed.

Or

Write a story, in 120 – 150 words, from the outline given below. Give a suitable title to the story.

A bee falls into a stream — a dove flies past — drops a leaf into the river — the bee climbs on it — escapes — a hunter aims at the dove — the bee stings the hunter — misses the aim — the dove is saved — moral. 5 Marks

Ans:

A bee fell into a stream once upon a time. To keep herself from drowning, she screamed for aid. A dove flying by the river noticed her and dropped a leaf into the water. Because the leaf was a light thing floating in the river, the bee climbed over it and was saved and escaped.

On another occasion, a hunter was about to shoot the dove. When the bee noticed him, he decided to assist the dove. She stung the hunter, causing him to miss his target due to discomfort. The dove is eventually rescued. They became lifelong friends when he thanked her for saving his life.

Moral of the story: Do good, and good will come to you.

SECTION – C

(Grammar) 15 Marks

7. Read the passage given below and fill in the blanks by choosing the most appropriate words from the given options. 1×3 = 3 Marks

A rich man from Punjab who (a) _____ to Rohtak to purchase land, (b) _____ of < 30 lakhs from his car on Monday. His son (c) _____ inside the car when the robbery took place.

(a) (i) come

(ii) came

(iii) was coming

(iv) coming

Ans: (ii) came

(b) (i) was robbed

(ii) is robbed

(iii) robbed

(iv) has robbed

Ans: (i) was robbed

(c) (i) is sitting

(ii) sat

(iii) was sitting

(iv) sits

Ans: (iii) was sitting

8. Complete the dialogue given below by filling in the blanks with the help of the options that follow : 1×3 = 3 Marks

Stranger : (a) _____ here ?

Policeman : They (b) _____the shooting of a film.

Stranger : Which film (c) _____ ?

(a) (i) Why are the people gather

(ii) Why have the people gathered

(iii) Why did the people gather

(iv) Why have the people gather

Ans: (iv) Why have the people gather

(b) (i) has come there to watch

(ii) had gone here to watching

(iii) have come here to watch

(iv) had come here to watch

Ans: (iii) have come here to watch

(c) (i) is being shot here

(ii) was being shot there

(iii) has been shooting here

(iv) has been shot there

Ans: (i) is being shot here

9. Look at the words and phrases given below. Rearrange them to form meaningful sentences as given in the example. 1×3 = 3 Marks

Example :

potter / in / once / a / a / lived / there / village /

Once there lived a potter in a village.

(a) innocent / was / a very / and / fellow / simple / he /

Ans: He was a very simple and innocent fellow.

(b) for him / a problem / old donkey, / his / had become /

Ans: His old donkey had become a problem for him.

(c) sold / it, / the donkey / the potter / fed up with / being /

Ans: The potter being fed up with the donkey sold it.

10. The following passage has not been edited. There is an error in each line against which a blank has been given. Write the incorrect word and the correction in your answer sheet against the correct blank number as given in the example. Remember to underline the word that you have supplied.

1×3 = 3 Marks

	Error	Correction
If your children is overweight,	**e.g. children**	**child**
avoids fruit but vegetables,	**(a) _____**	**_____**
and prefers computer games than real	**(b) _____**	**_____**
ones, you should being concerned.	**(c) _____**	**_____**

Ans: Error Correction

(a) but and

(b) than over

(c) being be

11. Do as directed : **1×3 = 3 Marks**

(a) He is too fat to run fast.

(Remove 'too' without changing the meaning)

Ans: He is very fast, so he has to run fast.

(b) We shall see her.

(Change the voice)

Ans: She shall be seen by us.

(c) He heard the happy news. He was overjoyed.

(Combine the sentences into a single sentence beginning with 'On hearing...')

Ans: On hearing the happy news, he was overjoyed.

SECTION - D

(Text Books and Long Reading Text) **25+10=35 Marks**

12. Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow :

1×3 = 3 Marks

Evergreen rainforests cover thirty percent of this district. During the monsoons, it pours enough to keep many visitors away. The season of joy commences from September and continues till March. The weather is perfect, with some showers thrown in for good measure. The air breathes of invigorating coffee. Coffee estates and colonial bungalows stand tucked under tree canopies in prime corners.

(a) Why is the monsoon season not the best period to visit Coorg?

Ans: It rains a lot during the monsoon season, making it difficult for people to travel and stay there. As a result, it is not the greatest time to visit Coorg.

(b) What is the best period for the visitors?

Ans: From September through March, the greatest time to visit Coorg is when there is a little rain, beautiful weather, and ripe coffee plants.

(c) Which word in the passage means the same as 'starts' ?

Ans: The term "commences" has the same meaning as "starts."

13. Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow :

1×3 = 3 Marks

I'm off my balance with joy, absolutely off my balance ! Oh, with all my soul ... I'll go and call Natasha, and all that.

(a) Who is the speaker?

Ans: "Stepan Stepanovitch Chubukov" is the speaker of these lines.

(b) Why is he so very happy?

Ans: He was overjoyed because Ivan Vassilevitch Lomov, a wealthy man, had promised to marry his daughter.

(c) Why is he going to call Natasha?

Ans: He is going to give a call to Natalya to set up a meeting with Lomov and ask for her approval to marry him.

14. Read the extract given below and answer the questions that follow :
1×3 = 3 Marks

Belinda tickled him, she tickled him unmerciful,

Ink, Blink and Mustard, they rudely called him Percival,

They all sat laughing in the little red wagon

At the realio, trulio, cowardly dragon.

(a) Who is Belinda ?

Ans: Belinda was a young lady who lived in a white house and had four pets: a cat, a mouse, a dog, and a dragon.

(b) How did Belinda and the other pets laugh at the dragon ?

Ans: Belinda and the other pets mock the dragon's cowardice.

(c) Which word in this extract means the same as 'unkind' ?

Ans: The term "unmerciful" refers to someone who is cruel.

15. Answer the following questions in 30 40 words each : **2×6 = 12 Marks**

(a) How can you say, 'bread-baking is still popular in Goa'?

Ans: We may say that 'bread-baking is still popular in Goa' because we still see moulds, mixers, appliances, and heralds selling bread.

(b) How did the Buddha teach Kisa Gotami the truth of life?

Ans: After Kisa Gautami's son died, Buddha requested that she bring a handful of mustard seeds from a residence where no one had perished. She couldn't find a residence where no one had died, so she was taught the truth of life: that all living things must die at some point.

(c) Give an example from the text to show that Mijbil is an intelligent animal.

Ans: Mijbil was a clever and sociable creature. He created the ping-pong game and was capable of splashing in the water. He also enjoyed playing with marbles and other types of games, demonstrating his intelligence.

(d) Why did Richard Ebright raise a flock of butterflies?

Ans: Richard Ebright created a horde of butterflies because she was fascinated by collections, and her mother encouraged her to read a book called "The Traves of Monarch X," which prompted her to do so.

(e) Why was Matilda sad after the ball?

Ans: After the ball, Matilda was disappointed because she had misplaced the diamond necklace she had borrowed from a friend. She was apprehensive about returning it because she couldn't afford such a pricey piece of jewellery.

(f) How did the book change Think-Tank's opinion about the Earthlings?

Ans: When Martian commander Think- Tank saw the book filled with nursery rhymes, he assumed it was a book written by Earthlings about how to invade Mars. As a result, he abandoned his intention to invade Earth and ordered his army to return to their home planet.

16. Answer the following question in 80-100 words : 4 Marks

Do you think Lutkins was right in befooling the lawyer and earning money by using unfair means ? What precautions should one take to avoid a situation like the one in which the lawyer was placed?

Ans: Lutkins erred by duping the lawyer and getting funds in an unethical manner. He should not have acted in such a shady manner, but the attorney also made a mistake. He should have taken a snapshot of Bill and double-checked with others because he was inexperienced.

Or

Behaviour of the conductor in 'Madam Rides the Bus' is an example of good manners. Mentioning the instances of good manners shown by the conductor in the story, write how you can make your life happy by observing good manners.

Ans: The bus conductor, indeed, is a model of courtesy and excellent manners. The bus conductor was a cheerful and light-hearted individual. Valli was a child when he lent her hand to climb on the bus. He was pleased by the kid's behaviour and treated Valli with respect, addressing her as "madam." He also assumed she was hungry and handed her the cold beverage. Throughout the ride, he was continually anxious about her.

Attempt either Part (a) or Part (b)

PART (a)

17. Answer the following question in about 100 words : 5 Marks

On the basis of diary entries of May 1944, explain her father's reaction to Anne's rebellious letter to him. What was it that brought about a change in her feelings towards her father ?

Ans: Her father responded to her defiant letters in a calming and consoling manner. He constantly mentored her and was a supportive parent, despite her complaints about her being so traditional and disapproving of her relationships. Anne's thoughts shifted from resentment and complaint to a better understanding of her father's nature, and she became closer to him.

18. Answer the following question in about 100 words : 5 Marks

Write a character sketch of Anne.

Ans: Anne Frank was a sensitive and empathic thinker and writer who lived during the Second World War. She was a keen political watcher. She also spoke about her thoughts on human nature. She was a delicate young lady who had suitors even at the tender age of thirteen. She was a war correspondent, and her diary has an explanation of the political events of the time. She clarified various points concerning the battle that was going on at the time. Despite a lot of criticism, she was a fiery and determined young lady.

Or

After reading the diary entries of Anne, what impression do you form about Mrs. Van Daan?

Ans: Mrs. Van Daan fit the stereotype of a stereotypical wife. She acted cordial and teasing to Anne Frank at first, but afterwards referred to her as an agitator. She is a pessimist and fatalist. She was conceited and prone to criticising, as well as flirty and obnoxious. She was always grumbling about her family, which Anne despised the most. She was unable to survive the war and was a target of Anne's wrath.

PART (b)

17. Answer the following question in about 100 words : 5 Marks

The allegation of plagiarism many a time suffocates a budding writer. How did Helen survive this allegation and start writing again ?

Ans: Helen was not guilty of plagiarising anything, but she was accused of plagiarising from Miss Canby's account. She was disillusioned and saddened as a fledgling writer after being accused of misrepresenting someone else's content as her own. She cried all night since she had been cross-examined in court, and she didn't write anything for a long time. Then, with the love and support of her followers, she regained the situation over time and wrote "the storey of my life."

18. Answer the following question in about 100 words : 5 Marks

Write a character sketch of Alexander Graham Bell as portrayed by Helen.

Ans: Alexander Graham Bell, the creator of the telephone, was a sensitive and empathetic individual. He had always been supportive of Helen's parents. When they were unsure about Helen's hearing problem, he advised them to admit her to the school of speech. As a result, Alexander played a crucial part in Helen's schooling. He was also aware of her feelings and preferences. He was a funny person, a brilliant poet, and an exceptionally patient and enthusiastic instructor, according to her.

Or

Helen had a special attachment to trees. Give two examples to illustrate her love for the trees.

Ans: Helen had a special bond with trees since she was a youngster. She appreciated the presence of a large, old oak tree. Because of its height, she dubbed it the "King of All Trees." In the storey, there was another linden tree to which she was devoted, and she was upset when it came off due to a thunderstorm. This demonstrates her love for nature and trees, which she used to associate with, despite her impairments, utilising her sixth sense.